38

Call From East Asia[1]

(1)
Berlin-Charlottenburg 2
Sophienstr. 6-7
22. Mai 1942.

YOUR EXCELLENCY,

Your Excellency is aware of the rapid developments in the Far East which have brought the Japanese forces to the frontiers of India. These developments have had their repercussions on events inside India, where conditions are now ripe for a revolution. India has now the opportunity to overthrow the British yoke and win her liberty—an opportunity which is rare in history. I, therefore feel that I must make the fullest use of this unique opportunity.

Looking back upon my stay here for little more than a year, I think that I have done some useful and enduring work for my country. But now the time has come when the final effort should be made for achieving India's political emancipation. For this purpose, it is absolutely essential that I should be in the East. Only when I am there, shall I be able to direct the revolution along the right channels.

I am profoundly grateful to the German Government—and to Your Excellency in particular—for the hospitality, assistance and kind consideration that I have received during my stay in Germany. This has served to forge the ties that will bind us together for all time. I am convinced more than ever before that the Tripartite Powers and India have a common destiny. Our common goal—the final defeat of Anglo-American Imperialism—demands that I should now go to the East and, from close quarters guide the Indian revolution towards that goal. Not only the cause

[1] Two letters to the German Government (1942).